

# The power of offloading.

What the chat logs show, and  
what I changed in my own course.

# EEG during essay writing

MIT Media Lab, 2025 · 54 students

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|            |                        |
|------------|------------------------|
| Brain only | strongest connectivity |
|------------|------------------------|

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|               |            |
|---------------|------------|
| Search engine | in between |
|---------------|------------|

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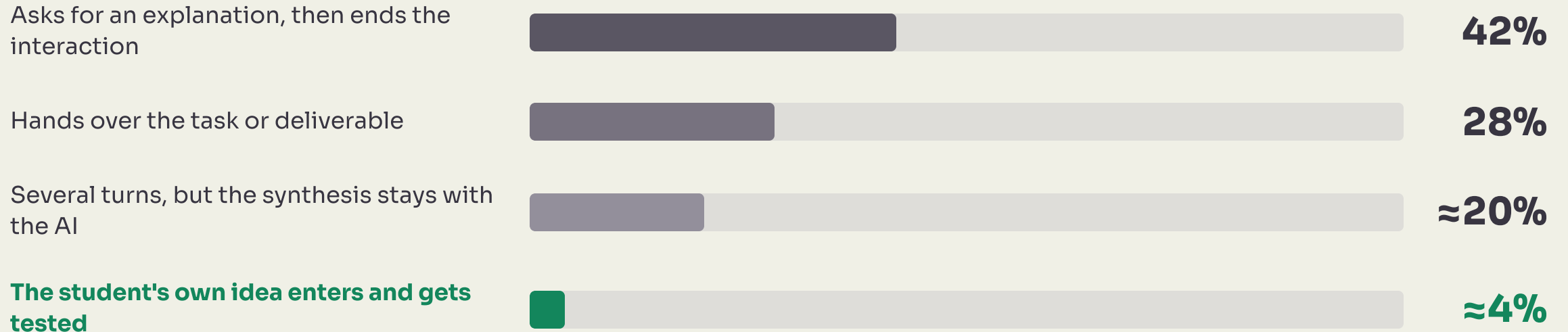
|     |         |
|-----|---------|
| LLM | weakest |
|-----|---------|

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**The LLM group showed weaker brain connectivity.**

# In search of constructive use

40,000 student messages to an AI tutor



Preliminary, descriptive categorisation

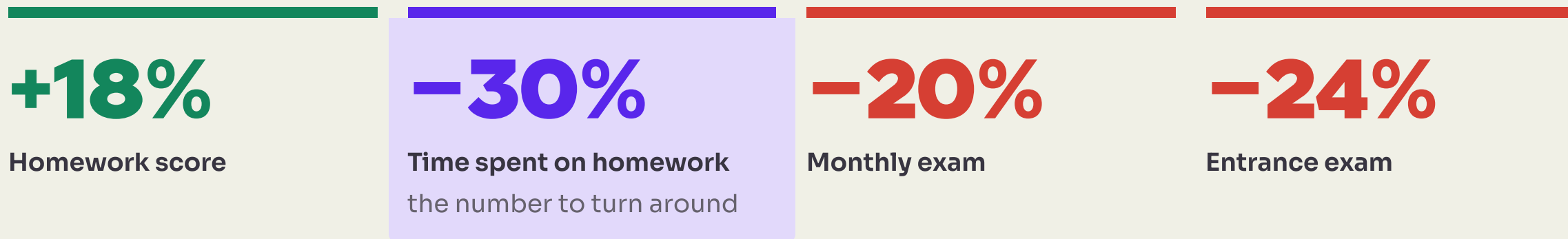
Tamási, *The Power of Outsourcing*, The European Sociologist 55, 2026

# **Our assignments reward the result**

**So the shortest path is the rational choice.**

# Better homework, weaker exams

26,811 Chinese secondary school students, 30 months



**+18%**

Homework score

**-30%**

Time spent on homework  
the number to turn around

**-20%**

Monthly exam

**-24%**

Entrance exam

Students who kept spending the time barely  
lost ground. **The lever is time on their own work.**

# **Our attempt: reward the process**

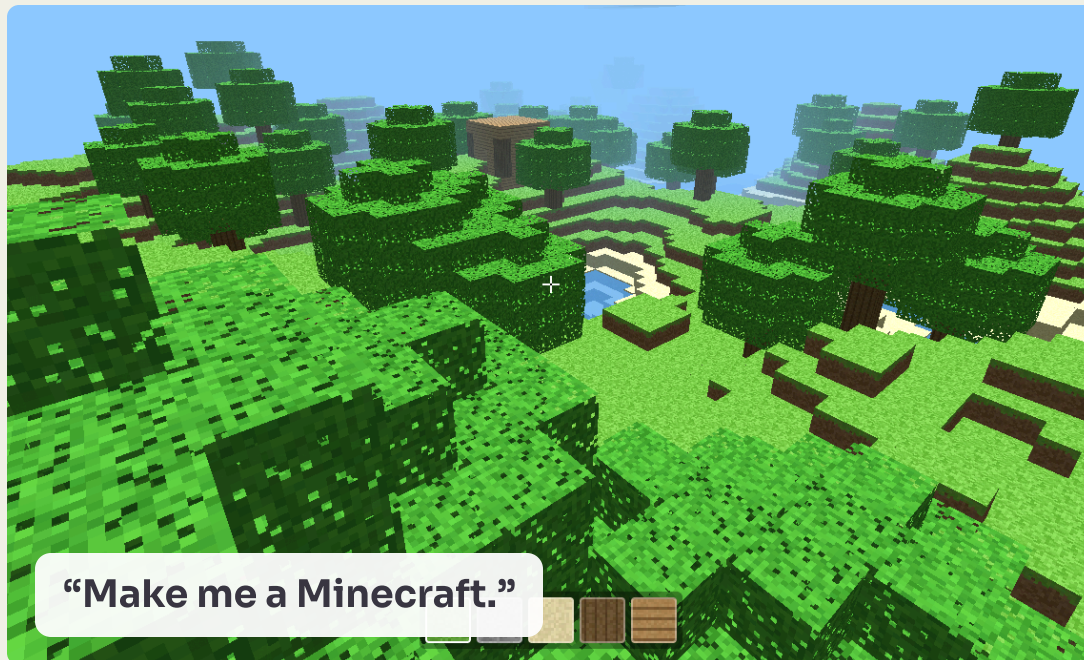
Two courses, 2025/26 - a course design trial, not an impact study

# Two programs, both built with AI

Vibe coding raises the floor, agentic engineering raises the ceiling.

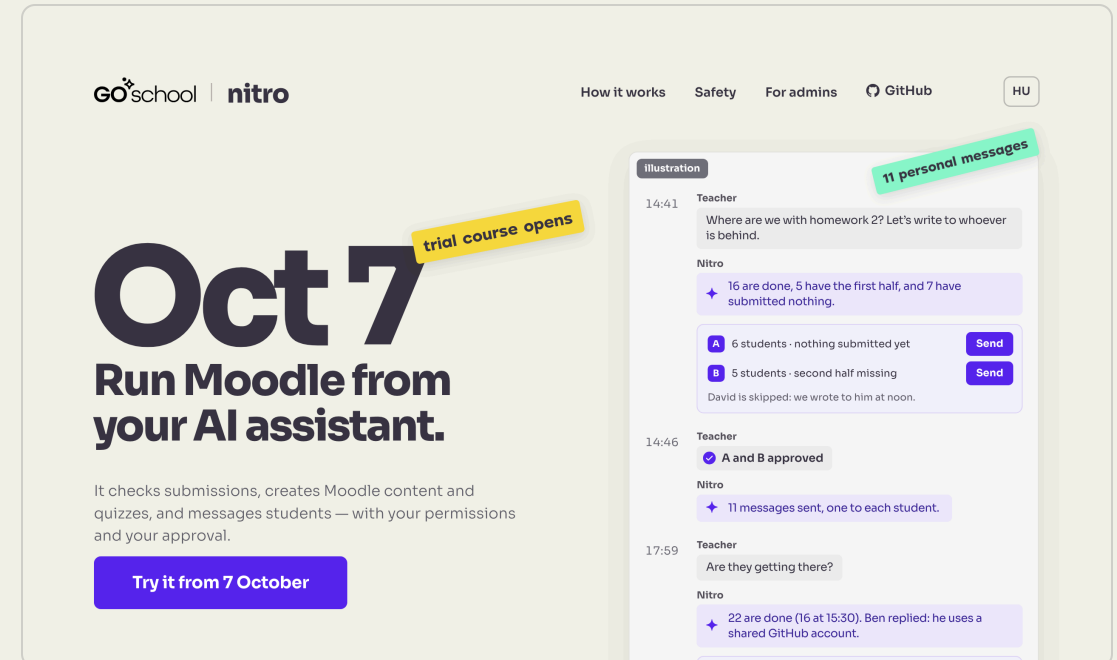
## Vibe coding

a playable 3D world from one sentence



## Agentic engineering

a Moodle plugin that teachers rely on



# Own project, own spec, own mistakes

Two courses: 28 students and 16 teachers, 44 own projects

## The -30%, turned around.

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Goal: more time on their own work, not less.

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- 01 Motivated to work on it
  - 02 Nothing to copy
  - 03 Helping each other is pure gain
  - 04 It's what work will expect
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# Leading them through the process

Weekly steps, so the process shows week by week

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## Project

A meaningful, well-defined problem

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## Plan

They revise it when the AI suggests better

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## Specification

They shape it, not just nod along

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## Spike

They test the risky points  
with a quick experiment

# For every word of mine, the AI read 44 and wrote 45

My two courses, September 2026 · 1,031 requests to the AI



**15k**

words I wrote

**655k**

words the AI read

**681k**

words the AI wrote

Time: about 115 hours in sessions, about 40 of them the AI working.

# Don't fight offloading. Use the time it frees.

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Which of your tasks would make that  
time worth the student's own work?



[arpadtamasi.github.io/innofair-2026](https://arpadtamasi.github.io/innofair-2026)

discussion